UNIT 3

Adjectives, comparison and number

This unit adds description, possession, comparison and counting to the noun and indicative-verb systems of Units 1–2. The grammar and vocabulary below supply the new material needed for independent practice. The final source passage has additional forms and constructions; its local help remains available throughout the reading tasks.

In tables, **m.**, **n.** and **f.** mean masculine, neuter and feminine; **sg.** and **pl.** mean singular and plural. **N/G/D/A** mean nominative, genitive, dative and accusative. Use the selected forms when a task requests them. A documented alternative may be valid Old English even when it does not meet that particular instruction. Length marks and the distinction between e and ę are retained.

1. Descriptive vocabulary

Adjective	Meaning	Inflection guide
gōd	good	long-stem model
glæd	glad	short stem; æ/a
micel	great; large	micl-/micel-
īdel	empty; void	īdl-/īdel-
ǣmtig	empty; void	retain ǣmtig-
æppelbǣre	fruit-bearing	-e adjective; æppelbǣr-
lȳtel	little; small	lȳtl-/lȳtel-
styriendlic	moving	regular long stem
lēof	dear	regular long stem
eald	old	regular long stem
yfel	bad; evil	selected full yfel- stem
gearu	ready	gearw-/gearo-
hēah	high	special contraction

Learn the meaning with the inflection guide. **Styriendlic** is an adjective meaning “moving”; its use here does not require a participle paradigm. The particular compound **æppelbǣre** is Cook’s word for “fruit-bearing”. The following tables and stem map give the complete selected forms of every adjective in this list.

2. Agreement and the two declensions

An adjective agrees with its own noun in gender, number and case. An attributive adjective belongs inside a noun phrase. A predicate adjective states something about the subject with the copula and is nominative. Agreement is grammatical: a neuter noun takes a neuter adjective regardless of the English meaning.

Ordinary adjectives have a **strong** and a **weak** declension. Use the strong form in a bare noun phrase and for an ordinary positive predicate adjective. Use the weak form after the article or a demonstrative. An article inside the subject does not make its predicate adjective weak. Comparatives are always weak; ordinals and superlatives have the rules given later.

The following examples are newly composed teaching material.

Gōd męte is on ðǣre eorðan.

Good food is on the earth.

Gōd agrees with the masculine nominative singular męte. The locative phrase retains the dative taught in Unit 1.

Se gōda mann hæfð gōdne męte.

The good man has good food.

Gōda is weak after se and agrees with the subject mann. Gōdne is strong masculine accusative singular and agrees with the bare object męte.

Đæt gōde trēo is micel.

The good tree is great.

Gōde is weak inside the determined subject phrase. Micel is a strong neuter nominative singular predicate.

A following ordinary adjective may be strong or weak after a possessive: Cook describes the weak form as occurring sometimes. Do not turn possession into an invariable weak-adjective rule. The exercises avoid requiring a new general rule for an adjective after a limiting noun genitive.

3. Complete strong and weak models

Strong gōd

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	gōd	gōd	gōd
Singular	Gen.	gōdes	gōdes	gōdre
Singular	Dat.	gōdum	gōdum	gōdre
Singular	Acc.	gōdne	gōd	gōde
Plural	Nom.	gōde	gōd	gōda
Plural	Gen.	gōdra	gōdra	gōdra
Plural	Dat.	gōdum	gōdum	gōdum
Plural	Acc.	gōde	gōd	gōda

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine gōde; neuter gōde.

The endingless feminine nominative singular and neuter nominative/accusative plural belong to the selected long-stem pattern. Masculine and feminine plurals need their own endings even when the English adjective is unchanged. Neuter nominative and accusative coincide in both numbers; they remain different cases.

Weak gōd

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	gōda	gōde	gōde
Singular	Gen.	gōdan	gōdan	gōdan
Singular	Dat.	gōdan	gōdan	gōdan
Singular	Acc.	gōdan	gōde	gōdan
Plural	Nom.	gōdan	gōdan	gōdan
Plural	Gen.	gōdra	gōdra	gōdra
Plural	Dat.	gōdum	gōdum	gōdum
Plural	Acc.	gōdan	gōdan	gōdan

The weak adjective has -a in masculine nominative singular, -e in feminine nominative singular and neuter nominative/accusative singular, and -an in the other singular cells. All genders share the plural forms. Its selected genitive plural is -ra; do not replace it mechanically with a weak noun's -ena. Cook also admits weak-adjective genitive plurals in -a and -ena. The comparative exceptions below are learned explicitly.

The distinct strong instrumental singular is recorded for recognition. It has the same spelling as several ordinary -e forms, so a spelling alone does not identify its case. No instrumental phrase or construction is required in independent production here. Weak instrumental forms coincide with the corresponding datives; no separate instrumental use is being introduced.

4. Stems and important exceptions

Short-stem glæd

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	glæd	glæd	gladu
Singular	Gen.	glades	glades	glædre
Singular	Dat.	gladum	gladum	glædre
Singular	Acc.	glædne	glæd	glade
Plural	Nom.	glade	gladu	glada
Plural	Gen.	glædra	glædra	glædra
Plural	Dat.	gladum	gladum	gladum
Plural	Acc.	glade	gladu	glada

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine glade; neuter glade.

The selected short-stem feminine nominative singular and neuter nominative/accusative plural have -u. Glæd uses glad- before the vowel endings and glæd- before -ne, -re and -ra. Its complete weak declension is the weak gōd pattern with glad- before -a, -e, -an and -um, but glæd- before genitive plural -ra. This gives a complete pattern; it is not a rule for changing æ to a in every adjective.

A complete application map

Use the two gōd tables with this map. **V-stem** is used before endings beginning with a vowel: -es, -um, -e, -a and -an. **C-stem** is used before -ne, -re and -ra. The strong masculine nominative singular and neuter nominative/accusative singular are the listed headword. The last two columns replace the corresponding endingless gōd cells. The strong instrumental singular is V-stem + -e. Thus every strong and weak N/G/D/A cell is determined; do not add an ending twice to a form already listed in the last columns.

Headword	V-stem	C-stem	Strong f. nom. sg.	Strong n. N/A pl.
gōd	gōd-	gōd-	gōd	gōd
glæd	glad-	glæd-	gladu	gladu
micel	micl-	micel-	miclu	miclu
īdel	īdl-	īdel-	īdel	īdlu
ǣmtig	ǣmtig-	ǣmtig-	ǣmtig	ǣmtig
æppelbǣre	æppelbǣr-	æppelbǣr-	æppelbǣru	æppelbǣru
lȳtel	lȳtl-	lȳtel-	lȳtlu	lȳtlu
styriendlic	styriendlic-	styriendlic-	styriendlic	styriendlic
lēof	lēof-	lēof-	lēof	lēof
eald	eald-	eald-	eald	eald
yfel	yfel-	yfel-	yfel	yfel
gearu	gearw-	gearo-	gearu	gearu

In micel, lȳtel and īdel, the medial vowel is lost before the selected vowel endings but retained before -ne, -re and -ra. The selected īdel feminine nominative singular is endingless, while its neuter plural is īdlu. Retain the full stem in ǣmtig and in the selected yfel pattern. A long disyllable does not license automatic deletion of every medial vowel.

In æppelbǣre the final headword -e is replaced by the endings, rather than treated as part of the stem. Its C-stem ends in r: adding -re or -ra therefore writes rr. Gearu has w before vowel endings but the selected gearo- before consonantal endings; its listed direct forms remain gearu. The map includes the weak declensions of both words.

Selected alternatives worth recognizing: strong feminine nominative micel or micelu beside miclu; lȳtel or lȳtelu beside lȳtlu; īdelu beside īdel. Corresponding neuter plurals may retain or omit -u, and strong feminine N/A plurals often have -e beside selected -a. These alternatives do not permit changing the actual spelling of a source passage. In particular, the reading prints miclu.

Hēah

Hēah loses h and contracts in much of its inflection. Use this complete selected pattern instead of attaching the ordinary endings directly to the headword.

Strong hēah.

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	hēah	hēah	hēa
Singular	Gen.	hēas	hēas	hēarre
Singular	Dat.	hēaum	hēaum	hēarre
Singular	Acc.	hēanne	hēah	hēa
Plural	Nom.	hēa	hēa	hēa
Plural	Gen.	hēarra	hēarra	hēarra
Plural	Dat.	hēaum	hēaum	hēaum
Plural	Acc.	hēa	hēa	hēa

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine hēa; neuter hēa.

Weak hēah.

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	hēa	hēa	hēa
Singular	Gen.	hēan	hēan	hēan
Singular	Dat.	hēan	hēan	hēan
Singular	Acc.	hēan	hēa	hēan
Plural	Nom.	hēan	hēan	hēan
Plural	Gen.	hēarra	hēarra	hēarra
Plural	Dat.	hēaum	hēaum	hēaum
Plural	Acc.	hēan	hēan	hēan

The selected hēaum has the supported alternative hēam. Hēanne may appear as hēane; hēarre/hēarra as hēare/hēara. The tables retain their selected doubling and vowel sequence. These forms show why consonant loss, doubling and contraction must be learned with the paradigm.

Reference: eall

Eall means “all”. Its strong morphology is for recognition here; no independent quantifier construction is required. Apply the complete strong gōd pattern with headword eall, V-stem eall-, C-stem eal-, feminine nominative singular eall and neuter N/A plural eall. The instrumental singular is ealle. The single l before -ne/-re/-ra is deliberate. Do not construct a weak paradigm from this reference.

5. Things and counted lights

Đing, neuter, means “thing”. Lēoht, neuter, can now also name an individual light or luminary. This counted sense differs from the mass sense “light” already learned. Both follow the complete heavy-neuter pattern:

Case	ðing sg.	ðing pl.	lēoht sg.	lēoht pl.
Nom.	ðing	ðing	lēoht	lēoht
Gen.	ðinges	ðinga	lēohtes	lēohta
Dat.	ðinge	ðingum	lēohte	lēohtum
Acc.	ðing	ðing	lēoht	lēoht

Use all four plural cases of counted lēoht productively. The unchanged spelling lēoht in nominative/accusative plural does not make it singular. Number is also shown by its determiner, numeral, adjective and clause context.

Adjectives — A1–A10

A1.
Give the complete strong nominative, genitive, dative and accusative of gōd in all three genders, singular and plural. Label every case even where spellings coincide.

A2.
Give the complete strong nominative, genitive, dative and accusative of glæd in all three genders, singular and plural. Mark the forms with a rather than æ.

A3.
Give the complete weak nominative, genitive, dative and accusative of gōd in all three genders, singular and plural. Contrast its genitive plural with a weak noun’s genitive plural.

A4.
For micel, lȳtel, īdel and ǣmtig, give the strong masculine genitive singular, strong feminine nominative singular, strong neuter nominative plural and weak neuter nominative singular. Preserve the selected stems and vowel marks.

A5.
For æppelbǣre, give the strong masculine and feminine nominative singular, masculine accusative singular, neuter nominative plural and genitive plural. Explain why the headword ends in -e. For gearu and hēah, give the strong masculine nominative, genitive, dative and accusative singular and the weak masculine nominative singular.

A6.
Give the four cases of ðing in the singular and plural. Give its meaning in the plural phrase ðā ðing.

A7.
These phrases are nominative. Add the appropriate article to each and change the adjective as needed: gōd fugol; gōd wyrt; gōd trēo; gōde fuglas. Keep the same case and number.

A8.
Translate and explain the different adjective forms: Đā gōdan fuglas sindon on ðǣm hofe. Đā fuglas sindon gōde.

A9.
Translate "The birds live in the good man's dwelling." Put the limiting genitive before the head noun. Identify the case of the dwelling and of the man.

A10.
The strong table contains gōde as masculine nominative plural and as masculine or neuter instrumental singular. State each analysis. Compare the corresponding entries of glæd.

6. Agreeing possessives

Possessor	Agreeing possessive	Meaning
the speaker	mīn	my
one addressee	ðīn	your
the speaker and one other	uncer	our, of us two
two addressees	incer	your, of you two
the speaker and others	ūre	our
several addressees	ēower	your

The stem identifies the possessor; the ending agrees with the possessed noun. A dual possessor can own one thing or several things. A plural possessive does not require its head noun to be plural. These agreeing

adjectives are distinct from the personal-genitive citation forms recognized in Unit 2. The third-person possessors his, hiere and hiera remain invariant.

Đū hæfst mīnne fisc.

You have my fish.

The possessor is the speaker. The possessed object is masculine accusative singular, so the selected possessive is mīnne.

Hīe hīerað ūre fuglas.

They hear our birds.

The possessors are the speaker and others; the birds are masculine accusative plural. The possessive therefore has the selected form ūre.

Mīn and ðīn

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	mīn	mīn	mīn
Singular	Gen.	mīnes	mīnes	mīnre
Singular	Dat.	mīnum	mīnum	mīnre
Singular	Acc.	mīnne	mīn	mīne
Plural	Nom.	mīne	mīn	mīna
Plural	Gen.	mīnra	mīnra	mīnra
Plural	Dat.	mīnum	mīnum	mīnum
Plural	Acc.	mīne	mīn	mīna

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine mīne; neuter mīne.

The complete ðīn paradigm is obtained by replacing mīn- with ðīn- in every cell, preserving every ending and doubled n. Its masculine/neuter instrumental singular is ðīne. These two long stems do not take the short-stem -u in the selected feminine nominative singular or neuter N/A plural.

Uncer and incer

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	uncer	uncer	uncru
Singular	Gen.	uncres	uncres	uncerre
Singular	Dat.	uncrum	uncrum	uncerre
Singular	Acc.	uncerne	uncer	uncre
Plural	Nom.	uncre	uncru	uncra
Plural	Gen.	uncerra	uncerra	uncerra
Plural	Dat.	uncrum	uncrum	uncrum
Plural	Acc.	uncre	uncru	uncra

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine uncre; neuter uncre.

The complete incer paradigm replaces uncer-/uncr- with incer-/incr- in the corresponding cells. Retain the medial e before -ne, -re and -ra; omit it before the selected vowel endings. Its instrumental singular is incre. Unsyncopated unceru/inceru are supported alternatives to uncru/incru, and single-r forms such as uncere/uncera or incere/incera occur beside the selected doubled-r forms.

Ūre and ēower

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	ūre	ūre	ūre
Singular	Gen.	ūres	ūres	ūrre
Singular	Dat.	ūrum	ūrum	ūrre
Singular	Acc.	ūrne	ūre	ūre
Plural	Nom.	ūre	ūru	ūra
Plural	Gen.	ūrra	ūrra	ūrra
Plural	Dat.	ūrum	ūrum	ūrum
Plural	Acc.	ūre	ūru	ūra

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine ūre; neuter ūre.

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	ēower	ēower	ēowru
Singular	Gen.	ēowres	ēowres	ēowerre
Singular	Dat.	ēowrum	ēowrum	ēowerre
Singular	Acc.	ēowerne	ēower	ēowre
Plural	Nom.	ēowre	ēowru	ēowra
Plural	Gen.	ēowerra	ēowerra	ēowerra
Plural	Dat.	ēowrum	ēowrum	ēowrum
Plural	Acc.	ēowre	ēowru	ēowra

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine ēowre; neuter ēowre.

Ūre has feminine nominative singular ūre, as well as masculine and neuter nominative singular ūre; its selected neuter plural is ūru. Keep the table's ūrre and ūrra distinct from the supported alternatives ūre and ūra. Ēower has ēowr- before vowel endings and ēower- before consonantal endings. Its supported unsyncopated -u alternative is ēoweru; single-r ēowere/ēowera also occur. These variants are valid alternatives, not reasons to ignore the selected paradigm when it is requested.

Possessives — P1–P6

P1.

Give the complete nominative, genitive, dative and accusative of the agreeing possessive mīn in all three genders, singular and plural. State what determines its ending.

P2.

Translate "I hear your bird. You hear my birds." Address one person.

P3.

Translate "We two have a dwelling. Our dwelling is small. You two have a tree. Your tree is great." Retain the two-person possessors.

P4.

Translate "Our birds live in your dwelling." The possessors are several speakers and several addressees.

P5.

Translate "His birds live in my dwelling. Their dwelling is greater than our dwelling." Use a male singular possessor for "his".

P6.
The phrases mīne fuglas and uncer fugol are clause subjects; ēowrum hofe follows locative on. Identify each possessor's person and number, then the possessed noun's gender, number and case. Which information comes from the possessive stem, and which from its ending?

7. Comparison

The positive names a quality; the comparative expresses a greater or lesser degree; the superlative expresses the highest or lowest degree. The regular series adds -ra and -ost. Eald has an umlaut series; the four remaining series have forms to learn separately. The comparative column gives masculine nominative singular. The superlative column gives the strong masculine/neuter nominative singular.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative	Degree meanings
lēof	lēofra	lēofost	dearer; dearest
eald	ieldra	ieldest	older; oldest
gōd	bętera	bętst	better; best
yfel	wiersa	wierrest	worse; worst
micel	māra	mǣst	greater/larger; greatest/largest
lȳtel	lǣssa	lǣst	smaller; smallest

Complete comparative inflection

A comparative is weak, including when it is a predicate with no preceding article. Māra supplies a complete model:

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	māra	māre	māre
Singular	Gen.	māran	māran	māran
Singular	Dat.	māran	māran	māran
Singular	Acc.	māran	māre	māran
Plural	Nom.	māran	māran	māran
Plural	Gen.	mārra	mārra	mārra
Plural	Dat.	mārum	mārum	mārum
Plural	Acc.	māran	māran	māran

For each other comparative, replace its final masculine nominative -a with -e for neuter/feminine nominative singular and neuter accusative singular;

with -an for the other singular cases and all nominative/accusative plurals; and with -um for all dative plurals. Use the following genitive plurals, which are the same in all genders. These explicit forms complete each comparative paradigm.

Masculine nom. sg.	**Genitive plural**
lēofra	lēofra
ieldra	ieldra
bętera	bęterra
wiersa	wiersena
māra	mārra
lǣssa	lǣssena

Do not form an extra sequence of r's by blindly appending -ra to the comparative stem. The selected -ena in wiersena and lǣssena is a licensed weak ending.

Superlatives

Every listed superlative takes the complete strong and weak gōd patterns, replacing gōd- with the printed superlative stem. All six are selected long-stem patterns: strong feminine nominative singular and neuter N/A plural are endingless; strong instrumental singular has -e. An ordinary attributive superlative is normally weak; the taught predicative use is strong. The weak masculine nominatives are:

Strong headword/stem	**Weak m. nom. sg.**	**Weak n./f. nom. sg.**
lēofost	lēofosta	lēofoste
ieldest	ieldesta	ieldeste
bętst	bętsta	bętste
wierrest	wierresta	wierreste
mǣst	mǣsta	mǣste
lǣst	lǣsta	lǣste

Use the same stem before all other strong/weak endings. This supplies complete inflection, not new partitive or substantival uses of the superlative.

A nominative standard with ðonne

Ðonne means “than” in the comparison taught here. When two subjects are compared with the copula, the second subject is nominative. The repeated copula can remain unexpressed. Restrict this pattern to the parallel copular comparison; it is not a rule for every clause containing “than”.

Se mann is ieldra ðonne se fugol.

The man is older than the bird.

Mann and fugol are the contrasted nominative subjects. Ieldra is weak masculine nominative singular although it is a predicate.

Comparison — C1–C7

C1.
Give the selected positive, comparative and superlative masculine nominative singular of lēof, eald, gōd, micel, lȳtel and yfel. Use the weak superlative forms.

C2.
Give the complete weak nominative, genitive, dative and accusative of māra in all three genders, singular and plural.

C3.
Give the strong nominative singular of mǣst in all three genders and its weak nominative singular in all three genders. Then give the genitive and dative plurals in both declensions.

C4.
Translate “The great tree is greater than the small tree.” Identify the case of both trees and explain why the comparative has its selected ending.

C5.
Translate “The bird is dearer than the fish. The old dwelling is better than the great dwelling.”

C6.
Translate these nominative phrases: “the oldest tree”; “the dearest bird”; “the greatest work”; “the best man”; “the smallest star”.

C7.
Explain and correct the adjective ending in Se fugol is lǣss. Keep the meaning “The bird is smaller.” Then change the corrected sentence to refer to several birds.

8. Adverbs and degree

An adverb qualifies an action, a statement, an adjective or another adverb. It does not agree in case, number or gender. The selected adjective citations wīd “wide”, swīð “strong” and sōð “true” are supplied bases for this formation; their adjective declensions are not assigned.

Positive adverb	Meaning	Comparative	Superlative
wīde	widely; far and wide	wīdor, more widely	wīdost, most widely
wel	well	bęt, better	bętst, best
swīðe	very	—	—
sōðlice	truly; indeed	—	—

The first derivation uses -e; sōðlice uses -lice. The regular adverbial comparative/superlative endings are -or/-ost. Memorize wel/bęt/bętst separately. An agreeing comparative adjective and the invariant adverb bęt perform different jobs. Swīðe can qualify an adjective. Sōðlice “truly” here is a new meaning distinct from the supplied connective use in the source reading.

Hīe geworhton ðā hofu wel.

They built the dwellings well.

Wel qualifies geworhton; the dwellings remain an accusative object with their own morphology.

Adverbs — V1–V4

V1.

Using the supplied adjective citation wīd, give the positive, comparative and superlative adverbs. Also form the adverb meaning “truly” from the supplied citation sōð. State which of these adverbs changes for gender, case or number.

V2.

Translate “The men built the good dwelling well.” Identify the adjective and the adverb, and state what each modifies.

V3.

Translate “He built the dwelling better.” Use the adverb meaning “better”. Then replace it with the adverb meaning “best”. Explain why neither word agrees with the dwelling.

V4.
Translate Sōðlice, ðæt weorc is swīðe gōd. Compare it with Ðæt weorc is gōd. What do the two adverbs add, and why do they have no adjective agreement endings?

9. Cardinal numbers: one through twelve

Ān modifies a singular count noun. Two and three take plural count nouns and inflect for the noun's gender and case. Four through twelve are used here in their ordinary invariant position before plural count nouns. The noun keeps the case required by its clause; counting does not supply a new noun dual. A dual personal subject still takes a plural verb, as in Unit 2.

Ān

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	ān	ān	ān
Singular	Gen.	ānes	ānes	ānre
Singular	Dat.	ānum	ānum	ānre
Singular	Acc.	ānne	ān	āne
Plural: reference only	Nom.	āne	ān	āna
Plural: reference only	Gen.	ānra	ānra	ānra
Plural: reference only	Dat.	ānum	ānum	ānum
Plural: reference only	Acc.	āne	ān	āna

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine āne; neuter āne.

Only the singular is used productively for cardinal "one". The plural table is for recognition/reference and does not authorize "one" with plural count nouns. The alternative masculine accusative singular ænne is valid beside selected ānne. A weak form meaning "alone" and independent numeral uses are not assigned.

Two and three

twēgen

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nom.	twēgen	twā	twā
Gen.	twēgra	twēgra	twēgra
Dat.	twǣm	twǣm	twǣm
Acc.	twēgen	twā	twā

ðrīe

Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Nom.	ðrīe	ðrēo	ðrēo
Gen.	ðrēora	ðrēora	ðrēora
Dat.	ðrīm	ðrīm	ðrīm
Acc.	ðrīe	ðrēo	ðrēo

All three genders share each numeral's genitive and dative. Nominative and accusative plural distinguish the selected gender forms. A recipient still takes the dative numeral and dative noun.

Wit habbað twā trēowu.

We two have two trees.

Wit identifies the speaker and one other; twā counts the neuter plural trees. These are separate grammatical choices.

Number	Selected cardinal
4	fēower
5	fīf
6	siex
7	seofon
8	eahta
9	nigon
10	tīen
11	endlefan
12	twęlf

Use these nine forms without case endings in the stated pre-nominal counting construction. Higher numbers, partitive genitives, and the inflection of postposed or substantival numerals are outside the present tasks.

Cardinals — N1–N5

N1.

Give the nominative, genitive, dative and accusative singular of ān in all three genders. Use the selected cardinal forms.

N2.

Give the nominative, genitive, dative and accusative of twēgen and ðrīe in all three genders. State which number their accompanying count nouns have.

N3.

Translate these nominative phrases: “two men”; “two herbs”; “two dwellings”; “three birds”; “three nights”; “three trees”.

N4.

Translate “We gave seed to two men. They gave water to three birds.”

N5.

Translate these nominative phrases: “four fish”; “five trees”; “six stars”; “seven days”; “eight birds”; “nine men”; “ten herbs”; “eleven years”; “twelve signs”. Explain the number of the nouns and the selected treatment of the cardinals.

10. Ordinals: first through seventh

Order	Selected masculine nom. sg.	Declension/stem
1	æresta	weak; æresta-
2	ōðer	strong, special ōðer pattern
3	ðridda	weak; ðridda-
4	fēorða	weak; fēorða-
5	fīfta	weak; fīfta-
6	siexta	weak; siexta-
7	seofoða	weak; seofoða-

Ordinals express position in an order. First and third through seventh are weak. The second, ōðer, remains strong even after the article. The case still follows the noun’s role; these ordinal forms do not introduce a new temporal use of on.

Complete ordinary ordinal pattern

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	ðridda	ðridde	ðridde
Singular	Gen.	ðriddan	ðriddan	ðriddan
Singular	Dat.	ðriddan	ðriddan	ðriddan
Singular	Acc.	ðriddan	ðridde	ðriddan
Plural	Nom.	ðriddan	ðriddan	ðriddan
Plural	Gen.	ðridra	ðridra	ðridra
Plural	Dat.	ðriddum	ðriddum	ðriddum
Plural	Acc.	ðriddan	ðriddan	ðriddan

For first and fourth through seventh, remove masculine nominative -a to obtain the printed stem, then apply every weak gōd ending, including genitive plural -ra and dative plural -um. Ðridda has the exceptional genitive plural ðridra, with one d before r; retain dd in its other cells shown above. No strong alternative is substituted merely because an ordinal lacks an article.

Ōðer

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	ōðer	ōðer	ōðru
Singular	Gen.	ōðres	ōðres	ōðerre
Singular	Dat.	ōðrum	ōðrum	ōðerre
Singular	Acc.	ōðerne	ōðer	ōðre
Plural	Nom.	ōðre	ōðru	ōðra
Plural	Gen.	ōðerra	ōðerra	ōðerra
Plural	Dat.	ōðrum	ōðrum	ōðrum
Plural	Acc.	ōðre	ōðru	ōðra

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine ōðre; neuter ōðre.

The selected feminine nominative singular is ōðru; ōðer and ōðeru are supported alternatives. Preserve ōðr- before the selected vowel endings, but ōðer- before -ne, -re and -ra. The article does not change this adjective to the weak pattern.

Ūre mann is on ðǣm ōðrum hofe.

Our man is in the second dwelling.

Ōðrum is strong neuter dative singular after the article; hofe is dative after locative on.

Ordinals — O1–O3

O1.

Give the nominative and genitive singular of “the second day”, “the second night” and “the second year”. Explain the declension of ōðer after the article.

O2.

Give the complete weak nominative, genitive, dative and accusative of ðridda in all three genders, singular and plural.

O3.

Translate “Three birds live in the first dwelling. The old man gave food to the fifth bird.”

11. Demonstratives

The article forms se, sēo, ðæt can also point to “that” or “those”. Their forms are familiar, but this pointing meaning is now assigned. Ðes, ðēos, ðis means “this”; its plural means “these”. A demonstrative agrees with its head noun. An ordinary adjective following it is weak. Relative uses and general third-person pronoun uses of these words are not introduced.

Se: that/those; also the familiar article

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	se	ðæt	sēo
Singular	Gen.	ðæs	ðæs	ðǣre
Singular	Dat.	ðǣm	ðǣm	ðǣre
Singular	Acc.	ðone	ðæt	ðā
Plural	Nom.	ðā	ðā	ðā
Plural	Gen.	ðāra	ðāra	ðāra
Plural	Dat.	ðǣm	ðǣm	ðǣm
Plural	Acc.	ðā	ðā	ðā

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine ðȳ; neuter ðȳ.

The table repeats the existing article morphology. The instrumental alternatives ðȳ and ðon remain recognition forms.

Đes: this/these

Number	Case	Masculine	Neuter	Feminine
Singular	Nom.	ðes	ðis	ðēos
Singular	Gen.	ðisses	ðisses	ðisse
Singular	Dat.	ðissum	ðissum	ðisse
Singular	Acc.	ðisne	ðis	ðās
Plural	Nom.	ðās	ðās	ðās
Plural	Gen.	ðissa	ðissa	ðissa
Plural	Dat.	ðissum	ðissum	ðissum
Plural	Acc.	ðās	ðās	ðās

Instrumental singular, recognition only: masculine ðȳs; neuter ðȳs.

Keep Cook's short-e spelling ðes. Do not choose a form from the English word alone: a recipient may require a dative singular demonstrative, while an object may require an accusative plural one.

Wē lufiað ðis lȳtle dēor.

We love this small animal.

Ðis and lȳtle are neuter accusative singular with the object dēor; the adjective is weak after the demonstrative.

Demonstratives — D1–D4

D1.
Give the complete nominative, genitive, dative and accusative of ðes in all three singular genders and in the plural.

D2.
Translate "This tree is great. That tree is small. These birds live in that dwelling."

D3.
Translate "I give seed to this man. I hear these birds."

D4.
Translate these nominative phrases: "this good man"; "these great trees"; "good men". Explain the declension of each adjective.

12. Cook, Group I, Exercise 4

Translate items 1–17. For a noun-phrase fragment, use a nominative head unless a task explicitly gives another case. Retain the dependent genitive's article and place that dependent before its head, as in the earlier Cook exercises. Complete sentences require the case appropriate to each clause role. Use the selected forms when practising a paradigm; the key distinguishes those targets from defensible alternatives.

Cook's introductory note reads: "[NOTE. — For adjectives preceded by a demonstrative, see 55.]" The reference is to his §55. Item 12 retains Cook's literal reference "(80)"; it points to the ordinal discussion.

1. The great whales.
2. The earth was empty and void.
3. The things were good.
4. The fruit-bearing trees.
5. The great lights.
6. The little star.
7. The smaller bird.
8. The larger tree.
9. The life of the good man.
10. The beginning of the seventh night.
11. The waters of the great sea.
12. The second (80) day and the second night.
13. The third day of the second year.
14. The food of the fifth man.
15. The light of the sixth evening.
16. The works of the moving creatures.
17. The morning of the first day.

Cook I.4.18, "Increase (sing.) and be multiplied.", is reserved for Unit 7, where its command and passive construction can be taught. It is not an additional task in this unit.

13. Controlled reading: Two dwellings and three birds

This connected account is newly composed teaching material. The old man is one of the builders. In his closing speech, ‘our’ includes all the builders.

> Đā gōdan męnn geworhton twā hofu. Ān hof wæs micel, and ān hof wæs lȳtel. Đæt micle hof wæs māre ðonne ðæt lȳtle hof. Hīe sealdon ðæt micle hof ðǣm ealdan męnn. Hē hæfde ðrīe fuglas. Hē sealde his fuglum sǣd and wæter. Đā fuglas lifdon on ðǣm miclan hofe. Se mann sægde: “Mīne fuglas sindon gōde. Ūre weorc is gōd.”

All words and constructions in this account have been taught. Track the case of each noun phrase before deciding who builds, gives, possesses or lives somewhere. Inside the direct quotation, the speaker’s first-person possessives refer to him and to the group identified in the orientation.

Controlled reading — L1–L5

L1.
Translate the complete new account “Two dwellings and three birds”. Keep the givers, recipient and possessed things distinct.

L2.
List the things counted by twā, ān and ðrīe in the account. Identify the gender, number and case of each numeral in its clause.

L3.
In the closing quotation, identify the possessor and the possessed noun in Mīne fuglas and Ūre weorc. Explain why the same final -e occurs with different gender and number analyses.

L4.
In the account, identify the strong predicate adjectives, the weak attributive adjectives and the comparative. Give the noun or pronoun governing each agreement.

L5.
Retell the first four sentences of the account in the present. Preserve all people, things, cases and adjective endings.

14. Source reading: the fourth day

This is the complete fourth-day account from Cook's first reading. Read the local help before translating. Its wishes, purpose clauses and resultative formulae are supplied; the adjective, numeral, noun and familiar indicative forms can be analysed with the systems learned so far. Do not infer that every form of a familiar verb has been taught.

> God cwæð ðā sōðlice, "Bēon nū lēoht on ðǣre heofonan fæstnesse, and tōdǣlen dæg and niht, and bēon tō tācnum, and tō tīdum, and tō dagum, and tō gēarum. And hīe scīnen on ðǣre heofonan fæstnesse, and ālīehten ðā eorðan"; hit wæs ðā swā geworden. And God geworhte twā miclu lēoht: ðæt māre lēoht tō ðæs dæges līehtinge, and ðæt lǣsse lēoht tō ðǣre niht līehtinge; and steorran hē geworhte. And gesęțte hīe on ðǣre heofonan, ðæt hīe scinen ofer eorðan, and gīemden ðæs dæges and ðǣre niht, and tōdǣlden lēoht and ðīestru; God geseah ðā ðæt hit gōd wæs. And wæs geworden ǣfen and męrgen se fēorða dæg.

Local forms and meanings

Source expression	Local help
cwæð	said; supplied third-person singular past of cweðan. The productive sęcgan paradigm does not supply this form.
ðā; sōðlice; nū	then; connective sōðlice (Cook compares Latin autem); now. The connective is distinct from the adverb “truly” learned above.
Bēon / bēon	let there be / let them be: plural present optative forms, expressing a wish or command. They are not infinitives or the indicative sindon.
heofonan	weak feminine heofone “heaven”: genitive singular before fæstnesse, but dative singular in on ðære heofonan. This is not the strong masculine heofon paradigm.
tōdǣlen; scīnen; ālīehten	let them separate; let them shine; let them illuminate. Supplied plural present optatives with the lights as subject.
tō tācnum / tīdum / dagum / gēarum	for signs / seasons / days / years. Tō governs these datives in a supplied function or purpose construction.
swā; geworden	thus, so; come to pass/become, a supplied past participle. Translate the complete formula as given below.
tō … līehtinge	for the illumination of … ; dative līehtinge contains a dependent genitive day or night.
gesętte	he set/placed; supplied past form of the prefixed verb. Its subject continues God/hē, although no subject is repeated in this clause. Hīe is the accusative object “them”.
ðæt hīe scinen …	so that they might shine … . Here ðæt introduces purpose. Preserve the short i in past optative scinen, contrasting present scīnen earlier.
ofer eorðan	over the earth. The whole phrase is supplied. Eorðan can be accusative or dative singular in this spelling; no unique choice is required.
gīemden; tōdǣlden	might rule over; might separate. Supplied plural past optatives continuing the purpose clause. Gīemden governs the following genitives.
geseah ðā ðæt …	then saw that … ; supplied strong past verb and content clause. Here ðæt is a conjunction, not an article.
męrgen	source variant of the already learned morgen “morning”; retain its spelling when reading or quoting this passage.

Whole constructions

Opening speech. God cwæð ðā sōðlice = God then said; sōðlice is connective here (Latin autem).

The wish. Bēon/bēon = let there be/let them be; tōdǣlen = let them separate; scīnen = let them shine; ālīehten = let them illuminate. All four verbs express the wish and take the lights as their plural subject.

Nested heaven phrase. on ðǣre heofonan fæstnesse = in the firmament of heaven. Heofonan is genitive singular and fæstnesse dative singular; ðǣre agrees with heofonan.

Assigned functions. tō tācnum/tīdum/dagum/gēarum = for signs/seasons/days/years; tō ... līehtinge = for the illumination of ...; genitive day/night is nested inside the dative phrase.

Fulfilment. hit wæs ðā swā geworden = it then came to pass thus / it was then so; geworden is supplied.

Setting the lights. And gesętte hīe = and he set them. The subject continues God/hē. on ðǣre heofonan = in heaven, with source weak-feminine dative.

Purpose clause. ðæt hīe scinen ... and gīemden ... and tōdǣlden ... = so that they might shine ... and rule over ... and separate ... . Scinen has short i; the present scīnen occurs earlier in the speech.

Over the earth. Ofer eorðan means “over the earth”. Either accusative or dative singular is possible here; the form eorðan does not decide between them.

Governed genitives. gīemden ðæs dæges and ðǣre niht = might rule over the day and the night. Here the verb governs the two genitives; this is not an of-relationship between nouns.

Seeing that it was good. God geseah ðā ðæt hit gōd wæs = God then saw that it was good. Ðæt is a conjunction, not the article. This clause pattern is supplied for the reading.

Closing day formula. And wæs geworden ǣfen and męrgen se fēorða dæg = and evening and morning came to pass, the fourth day. This is a supplied formula, including its word order and singular wæs.

The two occurrences of geworhte belong to the familiar indicative paradigm of gewyrcean. The paired greater and lesser lights use the new counted sense of lēoht. The text assigns their functions without naming the sun and moon. The final ordinal identifies the fourth day. The known wæs forms

within fulfilment formulae do not make the larger constructions independent production material.

Source reading — R1–R6

R1.
Translate the complete fourth-day Creation account using the local support. Preserve the command, fulfilment, purposes and closing day formula.

R2.
In twā miclu lēoht, identify the gender, number and case of all three words. Give their headwords and explain the selected adjective stem and ending.

R3.
Compare ðæt māre lēoht and ðæt læsse lēoht. Give the positive adjectives and the analysis of each comparative. Using the local purpose support, state the function assigned to each light.

R4.
Find the two ðæt forms that introduce the light noun phrases. Contrast them with the ðæt before hīe scinen and before hit gōd wæs, using the supplied clause notes.

R5.
Find both occurrences of geworhte and give their person, number and tense. Identify their objects. Explain why the supplied Bēon and scīnen are not forms of the same indicative pattern.

R6.
Analyse gōd in ðæt hit gōd wæs and fēorða in se fēorða dæg. Explain their agreement and their different declensions. Use the supplied closing-formula note for the larger clause.

15. Review

Use the taught forms and ordinary constructions independently. In X2, asterisks mark proposed errors to correct, not reconstructed historical forms. X3 permits more than one defensible composition; keep its stated meaning and referents clear.

Review — X1–X3

X1.

Translate “This good man gives my birds seed. My birds live in his small dwelling. The dwelling is greater than that tree.”

X2.

Correct the four marked adjective or numeral forms so that the sentences mean “The second day was good. My birds live in the great dwelling. The bird is smaller.”: Se *ōðra dæg wæs gōd. *Mīn fuglas libbað on ðǣm *micel hofe. Se fugol is *lǣss.

X3.

Write four connected Old English sentences: introduce two dwellings of unequal size, compare them, say that an old man has three birds, and give a direct quotation in which he says that he gives his birds food. Use an agreeing possessive in the quotation.

16. Source and editorial notes

The grammar follows Cook, **A First Book in Old English**, second edition (1895), §§55–70, 77–80 and 82–85, with the ordinary adjective/adverb uses in §§179–182. Wright's grammar corroborates stem variation, possessives and comparison. The bounded nominative comparison is supported by Fulk, §35. The tables distinguish selected teaching forms from supported alternatives. Forms expanded from a checked stem and paradigm need not be separately attested in a printed source.

Cook's Exercise I.4 is on printed p.2, one-based PDF p.10 of the selected exercise scan. Its original item wording and references are retained. The source reading is **First Book**, Reader I, printed p.125, editorially counted lines 8–15, and p.126, lines 1–4; one-based PDF pp.141–142. On p.125 the marginal line numbers 10 and 15 are printed; the other line numbers here are editorial counts. The new reading spans the whole fourth day.

The reading removes apparatus cues, joins line and page breaks, and rejoins the line-divided words tācnum and līehtinge. It otherwise preserves the source's letters, vowel marks and punctuation, including the colon after twā miclu lēoht. The following eighteen entries preserve Cook's apparatus for this span. Questions in these historical notes are not additional assigned exercises; use the local support above for forms beyond this unit.

Printed page/note	Cook's note
125/15	Lat. autem.
125/16	See 166.
125/17	Gen. sing.
125/18	See tōdǣlan.
125/19	See tācen, and 24.
125/20	See tīd, and 24.
125/21	See dæg, and 24.
125/22	See gēar.
125/23	See 193. a. Write the opt. pret. plur. of this verb.
125/24	See twēgen.
125/25	See micel.
125/26	See 66.
125/27	What is the relation of the stem-vowel of this word to that of lēoht?
125/28	For niht, instead of nieht, see 19. See 153. d.
125/29	See gesęttan, and 189, note.
126/1	Opt. pret. = Lat. lucerent. What would be the opt. pres.?

Continued on the following page.

Printed page/note	Cook's note
126/2	See 156. f.
126/3	See 78.

In these notes "opt." means optative, Cook's term for the forms commonly called subjunctive. The supplied present/past contrast is sufficient for this reading. His historical vowel question does not require an additional sound-change exercise here.